

Digital Cash

The infrastructure layer for institutions that want to operate digital cash properly. Everything on one page: who the customer is, why they buy, and what the product does — and does not do.

Owner: Commercial · Confidential

THE CUSTOMER IN ONE LINE

An **already-licensed institution** with a concrete digital cash, settlement, treasury or liquidity use case — and the internal maturity to move past research into live operation.

THE BUYER

Executive sponsor + committee

At already-licensed banks and financial institutions.

THE CYCLE

6-18 months

An institutional decision, run at institutional pace.

THE LINE

The customer's own licence

Aryze provides the rails — never issuer, never operator.

Part 1 — The customer

Definition

Digital Cash is **enterprise operating infrastructure** — the opposite end of the spectrum from Stablecoin Factory's self-serve deployment layer. The institution remains issuer and operator under its own licence; Aryze delivers the infrastructure behind it.

This customer is not after a demo or a pilot with no execution path. They have an institutional need, a budget that can fund an infrastructure engagement, and a buying committee that spans treasury, legal, compliance, risk and technology.

Strongest institution types, in order

1 Banks with tokenised-deposit programmes

Typically tier-2/3 banks following JPM, Citi, BBVA and Santander.

2 Banks with intra-bank settlement needs

Clearing between branches or with correspondent banks.

3 Licensed financial institutions & fintech clusters

Licensed financial institutions with digital-asset programmes; and fintech clusters with clearing or settlement needs between participants (especially EMI and PI licence holders).

4 Conglomerates, treasury operators, financial operators & central banks

Licensed conglomerates moving value across subsidiaries; institutional treasury or liquidity operators (funds, market makers, asset managers with settlement needs); financial operators needing digital-cash infrastructure under their own permissions; and central banks with wholesale CBDC experiments — rare, strategically important.

What the customer wants

"Operate digital cash under our own licence, with full institutional infrastructure behind it."

The institution wants control, credibility and operational depth — not speed alone. Issuance by itself does not solve settlement, liquidity, treasury, ramps, compliance, auditability, interoperability, reporting or integration with existing systems. Institutions that get serious about digital cash hit a wall between ambition and operational readiness. Digital Cash is the layer that closes that gap.

The pains we solve

- 1. Issuance is not operation.** Simple issuance solves none of settlement, liquidity, treasury, ramps, compliance, auditability, interoperability, reporting or integration.
- 2. An internal build is slow, expensive and complex.** Typically 12–24 months and five or more full-time engineers for a serious in-house stack.
- 3. Governance stakeholders demand a credible operating model.** Pilots without an operating story do not pass the risk committee; treasury will not move money onto a proof of concept.

- 4. Integration with existing systems is hard.** Core banking, treasury management, ledger engines and wallets are legacy infrastructure that must be respected.
- 5. They want control without building everything.** The classic build-vs-buy tension at institutional scale.
- 6. Regulator readiness.** The institution must be able to answer "how do you operate this?"
- 7. Multi-party complexity.** Settlement involves multiple counterparties; interoperability and standards conformance are not optional.

Fit & walk-away signals

Strong-fit signals — the more that are present, the better the fit:

Licensed, with the licence covering digital cash or related activity

A concrete use case — tokenised deposits, intra-bank settlement, treasury, multi-currency liquidity, RWA settlement

Internal maturity to engage all functions at once

Existing infrastructure to integrate, not replace

Budget framed as capex/opex, not a pilot

An executive sponsor identified, or a path to one

A multi-year horizon — they do not expect to be live in six weeks

A working regulator relationship

Counterparties and an ecosystem that can support settlement

Walk-away signals — when these are true, it is not a fit:

Unlicensed buyer — outside the fit, and a candidate for re-routing or disqualification

Wants Aryze as issuer or regulated operator — not the product

Only needs simple stablecoin deployment — a fit for Stablecoin Factory

Pure research mode, without an execution path or budget

Cannot support legal, compliance and risk review

No executive sponsor and no path to one

Wants a product demo out of curiosity, with no operating need

Expects deployment in weeks — wrong scale for institutional infrastructure

In conflict with their regulator — Aryze cannot solve an existing compliance issue

Wants everything custom-built from scratch — Aryze is infrastructure, not a consulting build

Best-fit institution profile

- **Already licensed** — and the licence covers digital cash issuance or related activity
- A **concrete use case** — not "we are exploring tokenised deposits" but "we must settle intra-bank transactions with tokens before end of 2026"
- The internal maturity to engage treasury, legal, compliance, risk and technology at the same time
- Existing infrastructure that must be integrated, not replaced — core banking, treasury management, ledger, wallets
- Budget framing as a capex/opex line, not a pilot budget
- An identified **executive sponsor** — typically board-adjacent
- Able to carry a 6–18 month sales and implementation cycle without losing interest

Buying triggers

- A compliance deadline — regulators requiring settlement modernisation, or MiCA pressure on the operating model
- A peer move — a peer bank announces tokenised deposits, and the institution must follow or fall behind

- A validated use case — the pilot phase is over, now it must go live
- The cost of existing settlement rails — correspondent fees, T+2 settlement cost, FX cost
- Liquidity pressure — treasury wants faster settlement to free up capital
- Strategic positioning — the board or executive team has put digital cash on the roadmap
- Regulator consultation — invited into regulatory dialogue and needing to show capability
- Acquisition preparation — positioning as a strategic asset

Who buys

The buying committee is much wider than a merchant sale. **Primary:** the executive sponsor (board-adjacent — CFO, COO or Chief Digital Officer; the role matters early, since deals do not close without an internal champion at executive level), Head of Treasury, Head of Transaction Banking, Head of Payments, the Digital Assets lead (usually programme owner), CFO and COO. **Secondary but decisive:** CIO/CTO on integration, the Chief Compliance Officer / MLRO on regulatory framing, General Counsel on legal structure, and the risk committee.

The executive sponsor is the pivotal role. Without one identified, the engagement tends to remain an open-ended discussion rather than a deal.

Qualification questions for the first institutional conversation

1. **Licence status:** which licence do you operate under, and what does it cover for digital cash, tokenisation or settlement?
2. **Use case:** tokenised deposits, settlement, treasury, multi-currency, RWA settlement, or something else?
3. **Trigger:** why is this a 2026 conversation rather than 2025 or 2027?
4. **Executive sponsor:** who is it internally, and who from treasury, legal, compliance, risk and technology will be in the room?
5. **Existing infrastructure:** what must this integrate with?
6. **Governance and audit:** what requirements does your institution put on a programme like this?
7. **Time horizon:** pilot, phased, or full operation?

8. Budget framing: funded, or still building the business case?

Questions #1, #2, #4 and #7 — licence status, use case, executive sponsor and time horizon — are the ones a concrete proposal depends on.

How we position it

"Enterprise infrastructure for already-licensed institutions that want to operate digital cash under their own licence, with the full operating layer — settlement, ramps, treasury, multi-currency, interoperability — needed to move from issuance to live operation."

The positioning centres on control, credibility and infrastructure depth, in institutional rather than Web3 terms. This customer needs institutional operating infrastructure, not a stablecoin tool.

Market context

- **MiCA is fully operational** — EU institutions must position under the new framework
- **The EU Digital Euro project** gives institutional digital cash legitimacy and attention
- **Tier-1 banks have launched tokenised deposits** (JPM Coin, Citi Token Services, BBVA, Santander) — pressure on tier-2/3 banks to follow
- **Wholesale CBDC pilots** run in the UK (BoE), EU (ECB) and Switzerland (SNB Project Helvetia)
- **DLT-based settlement is gaining acceptance** — Project Agora (BIS) and Project mBridge are no longer just research
- **Cross-border correspondent banking still costs 5-8%** in many corridors — the incentive for DLT settlement is real
- **Tokenised T-bills and money-market funds** (BlackRock BUIDL, Franklin OnChain, Ondo) create settlement needs for institutional liquidity flows

The competitive field

COMPETITOR	POSITION

Finality	Bank-consortium project for tokenised central-bank money. Strong credibility, limited to consortium members, long implementation.
Partior	Bank consortium (DBS, JPM, Standard Chartered) for cross-border settlement. Strong in Asia.
JP Morgan Onyx / JPM Coin	Internal tokenised deposits — JPM ecosystem only.
Adhara	DLT platform for wholesale CBDC and bank settlement.
R3 Corda	Enterprise DLT platform, widely used by banks — more platform than operating layer.
Quant Network	Enterprise blockchain interoperability.
Fireblocks	Institutional custody and token operations — competitor on the custody/wallet layer.
Tassat	US bank tokenisation infrastructure.

Aryze's positioning acknowledges these competitors rather than claiming blanket superiority over Finality or Partior — they are consortium projects, while Aryze is an infrastructure provider to single institutions. Digital Cash occupies the space those projects leave open: operating depth under the institution's own licence without consortium lock-in, Mastercard on-ramp integration, and a migration path from Stablecoin Factory where relevant.

Part 2 — The value proposition

The institution's jobs

FUNCTIONAL

Issue digital cash under their own licence and governance; run programmes that meet treasury, settlement, liquidity or value-movement needs; settle transactions on-ledger with credible operational backing; manage liquidity and reserves on a token basis; operate on/off-ramps to traditional payments; integrate with existing core banking, treasury management, ledger and wallet systems; move assets across networks and counterparties; issue in multiple currencies.

PROFESSIONAL

Satisfy internal stakeholders — legal, compliance, risk, treasury, technology — with credibility and operational depth; stand behind the programme in front of regulators, the board and the risk committee; demonstrate institutional capability to peer banks and counterparties.

EMOTIONAL

Confidence that the programme stands up to regulator scrutiny; trust that the infrastructure provider is not a single point of failure; pride in a credible operating model rather than a proof of concept; control — it is the institution's programme, not Aryze's.

From pain to relief

Operating model — issuance is not operation. Without an operating story, pilots strand and never reach live; the risk committee does not approve.



Operating story built in — settlement, ramps, treasury and multi-currency form one coherent stack. Pilots can move to live operation without re-platforming. The risk committee sees a credible operating model.

Build — an internal build is slow (12–24+ months), expensive (5+ engineers) and complex; the vendor stack is fragmented and integration risk is high.



One operating layer — one coherent operating layer replaces the multi-vendor stack. Pre-built infrastructure cuts the custom-build burden. The timeline matches institutional reality — months, not weeks, but not two-plus years.

Governance & compliance — stakeholders demand a credible operating model, not a marketing deck; AML/KYC/sanctions screening must be built in; auditability and reporting are strict; the legal structure is complex.



Native governance — AML/KYC/sanctions hooks, auditability and reporting are native, not bolted on. The customer remains issuer and operator — a clean legal position toward regulators.

Integration — core banking, treasury systems, ledger engines and wallet providers must all connect; legacy infrastructure has to be respected.



Integration is part of the stack — integrations with core banking, treasury, ledger and wallet providers are part of the infrastructure, not a post-deployment task. Standards conformance cuts regulatory friction. Mastercard on-ramp integration avoids separate vendor onboarding.

Control — they want control without building everything internally; they fear vendor lock-in and resist outsourcing regulated activity.



The institution keeps control — Aryze is infrastructure provider, not programme operator — the institution keeps control, with a preserved migration path instead of lock-in.

Strategic — peer pressure from banks announcing tokenised deposits; the risk of being left behind; no clear story for the board; programmes drown without an executive sponsor.



A story for the board — a story the institution can stand behind in front of the board, a credible partner for the executive sponsor to present, and peer

positioning against banks that build alone or wait.

The pains

TYPE	PAIN
Operating model	Issuance is not operation. Without an operating story, pilots strand and never reach live; the risk committee does not approve.
Build	An internal build is slow (12–24+ months), expensive (5+ engineers) and complex. The vendor stack is fragmented, integration risk is high, and few people have built an institutional digital-cash stack before.
Governance & compliance	Stakeholders demand a credible operating model, not a marketing deck. AML/KYC/sanctions screening must be built in. Auditability and reporting requirements are strict. The legal structure is complex.
Integration	Core banking (Temenos, Finastra, Avaloq, in-house), treasury systems (Kyriba, Bloomberg), ledger engines and wallet providers must all connect — legacy infrastructure has to be respected.
Control	They want control without building everything internally; they fear vendor lock-in and resist outsourcing regulated activity.
Strategic	Peer pressure from banks announcing tokenised deposits; the risk of being left behind; no clear story for the board; programmes drown without an executive sponsor.

The gains

LEVEL	GAIN
Required	Controlled issuance under their own licence. Full operational infrastructure behind the token. A credible operating model they can explain to regulators and the board. Integration with existing systems. Settlement, ramps, treasury and multi-currency capability.

Expected	A multi-year infrastructure partnership, not a transactional vendor. Governance hooks — controls, approvals, audit trails. Reporting integrations. Standards conformance (ISO 20022, FATF, MiCA where relevant). Mastercard-related on-ramp services. 24/7 institutional support.
Desired	Interoperability across networks and counterparties. Asset movement across private and public DLT. A clear migration story from Stablecoin Factory. Configurable token design per use case.
Unexpected	A team with payments-operational background, not just technical depth. Mastercard-partnership credibility. A path into the broader ecosystem — BIS Agora, Project mBridge, regulatory dialogue.

What we deliver

- **The Digital Cash operating infrastructure** — settlement, on/off-ramps, treasury functionality, multi-currency issuance, interoperability, asset movement and governance hooks in one stack
- **On/off-ramps** between digital cash and traditional payments, via the Mastercard Open Banking partnership
- **Governance hooks** — controls, approvals and audit trails that match the institution's governance model
- **Reporting and integration** with existing treasury, banking, wallet and ledger systems
- **Enterprise SLA and 24/7 institutional-grade support**
- **A multi-year infrastructure partnership** — partner, not transactional vendor

How that relieves the pains

PAIN	RELIEF
Operating model	The operating story is built into the infrastructure — settlement, ramps, treasury and multi-currency form one coherent stack. Pilots can move to live operation without re-platforming. The risk committee sees a credible operating model.
Build	One coherent operating layer replaces the multi-vendor stack. Pre-built infrastructure cuts the custom-build burden. The timeline matches institutional reality — months, not weeks, but not two-plus years.

Governance	AML/KYC/sanctions hooks, auditability and reporting are native, not bolted on. The customer remains issuer and operator — a clean legal position toward regulators.
Integration	Integrations with core banking, treasury, ledger and wallet providers are part of the infrastructure, not a post-deployment task. Standards conformance cuts regulatory friction. Mastercard on-ramp integration avoids separate vendor onboarding.
Control	Aryze is infrastructure provider, not programme operator — the institution keeps control, with a preserved migration path instead of lock-in.
Strategic	A story the institution can stand behind in front of the board, a credible partner for the executive sponsor to present, and peer positioning against banks that build alone or wait.

Digital Cash vs Stablecoin Factory — the distinction

QUESTION	DIGITAL CASH	STABLECOIN FACTORY
Who is issuer?	The institution	The builder
Who operates?	The institution (institutional scale)	The builder (self-serve)
Aryze's role	Operating infrastructure	Deployment infrastructure
Sold on	Control, credibility, infrastructure depth	Speed, simplicity, deployment path
Sales cycle	6–18 months	Weeks to a quarter
Buyer	Executive sponsor + treasury, MLRO, GC, risk	Founder, CTO, product or innovation lead

Part 3 — The product

Overview

Digital Cash is built for institutions that need more than simple issuance. These customers are not looking for a token demo — they need the operating infrastructure required to make digital cash work in real financial environments: settlement, on/off-ramps, treasury functionality, multi-currency issuance, interoperability, and asset movement across environments.

The positioning is precise: Aryze delivers infrastructure. The customer remains issuer and operator under their own licence. That distinction is central. Digital Cash is not the product for customers who only need a lightweight stablecoin test — that is Stablecoin Factory.

Enterprise operating infrastructure for already-licensed institutions to issue and operate digital cash under their own licence, governance and control.

What's in the box

In the box — confirmed

- ✓ **Issuance** — under the institution's own licence; Aryze is not the issuer.
- ✓ **Settlement** — supporting clearing and settlement between participants.
- ✓ **On/off-ramps** — between digital cash and traditional payments, via the Mastercard Open Banking partnership.
- ✓ **Treasury functionality** — liquidity management and reserve handling.
- ✓ **Multi-currency issuance** — several currencies on the same operating layer.
- ✓ **Interoperability & asset movement** — moving assets across environments (private and public DLT), networks and counterparties.
- ✓ **Governance hooks** — controls, approvals and audit trails matching the institution's governance model.
- ✓ **Reporting & integration** — with existing core banking, treasury management, ledger and wallet systems.
- ✓ **Operations** — enterprise SLA, 24/7 institutional-grade support, a multi-year partnership model, standards conformance (ISO 20022, FATF, MiCA where relevant), and built-in AML/KYC/sanctions-screening hooks.

Deliberately not in the box

- **Aryze does not hold the customer's licence** and takes on no regulated activity.
- **Aryze does not become the issuer** — the institution issues.
- **Aryze does not operate the programme** — the institution operates under its own licence.
- **No "live in six weeks"** — the cycle is 6–18 months, and speed is not the proposition.
- **No "plug-and-play"** — the term does not hold up with an institutional buying committee.
- **No consortium building** — that is Finality/Partial territory; Aryze serves single institutions.
- **No central-bank functions and no licence delivery.**
- **Specific networks, jurisdictions and custody partners** are confirmed per deal.

How it is sold

An enterprise sale: long cycle, wide committee, high consideration. Channels: direct institutional outreach, warm introductions via advisors, lawyers, regulators and industry bodies, institutional events (Sibos, Money20/20, Point Zero, Digital Assets Week), strategic partnerships, inbound RFPs and regulator-driven introductions.

The typical path: multi-touch discovery (surface the use case, confirm the licence, identify the executive sponsor) → a workshop with treasury, compliance and technology in the room → solution architecture against the existing stack → commercial framing with phased deployment → legal, risk and procurement (expect months) → pilot or phase-1 deployment → live operation and expansion. **6-18 months is normal, and speed is not the proposition.**

How Digital Cash is described

- **The language used:** Aryze as the infrastructure provider; regulatory complexity acknowledged rather than waved away; operational, institutional terms — settlement, liquidity, governance, auditability — in place of Web3 jargon.
- **The language avoided:** "we'll issue the digital cash for you" · "Aryze becomes your operator" · "live in weeks" · "plug-and-play" · "stablecoin" used loosely — institutions can dislike the term, and the customer's own language tends to prevail: digital cash, tokenised deposits, settlement asset.

Pricing

Priced as an enterprise infrastructure engagement, depending on scope (settlement only / treasury / multi-currency / full), volume framing, integration depth and the multi-year commitment. A number is not quoted before the use case and integration have been scoped; pricing is framed once that scope is understood.